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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part IV

International cooperation for development

Section 12

Trade and development

Programme 10

Trade and development

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 12)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 12)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 12.1 The United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) is responsible for assisting developing countries in integrating beneficially into the global economy in support of inclusive, resilient and sustainable growth and development. This task is more critical than ever, in light of the profound transformations, climate change and environmental challenges, geopolitical tensions, growing conflict, increasing macroeconomic challenges and growing systemic risks. In the Geneva Consensus, the outcome document of the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD, the member States of UNCTAD reaffirmed that international trade remains a powerful means for economic growth, structural transformation and the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals, but that developing countries with limited productive capacities and trade infrastructure have challenges integrating into regional and global value and supply chains. They also emphasized the need for multilateral cooperation and multilateralism to boost sustainable development and the building of an open and prosperous global economy. In the Geneva Consensus, UNCTAD is requested to continue to enhance the ability of countries to build a fairer, more equitable, resilient, inclusive, just and sustainable world, while giving priority consideration to the needs and interests of developing countries. Therefore, UNCTAD will support least developed countries, landlocked and transit developing countries, small island developing States, African countries, other structurally weak and vulnerable and small economies, net-food-importing developing countries and countries in conflict and post-conflict situations, while also taking account of the challenges facing middle-income countries. Moreover, UNCTAD remains the focal point within the United Nations system for the integrated treatment of trade and development and interrelated issues in the areas of finance, technology, investment and sustainable development, and it will also contribute to supporting implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 12.2 The global economy continues to face subdued economic growth, with persistent inequalities within and among countries. Economies, particularly the most vulnerable, are affected by compounding challenges, including uncertainty related to trade, limited fiscal space, weak investment levels, high and unsustainable debt burdens, digital divides and fragile productive capacities. Therefore, fostering more inclusive and sustainable development and enhancing resilience to these challenges will continue to guide the work of UNCTAD, in accordance with the particular needs and challenges of the member States and the priority areas set out in the Geneva Consensus. In line with its mandate, UNCTAD will continue to rely on its three interrelated pillars of work: (a) conducting high-quality and evidence-based research and policy analysis that contribute to national, regional and international policies with the aim of generating inclusive and sustainable development under the principle of leaving no one behind; (b) providing technical cooperation to developing countries on the basis of such analysis; and (c) bringing member States together through its intergovernmental machinery to build consensus on policies that allow developing countries to maximize the opportunities of globalization and economic integration, as well as to address cross-cutting economic, social and environmental challenges.
- 12.3 UNCTAD will remain committed to addressing interrelated issues essential to all countries in attaining sustainable and equitable growth and development, while being particularly mindful of the needs and priorities of developing countries. UNCTAD will also support developing countries with work on South-South and triangular cooperation, as a complement to and not a substitute for North-South cooperation, and regional integration.

- 12.4 In accordance with its mandate in the interrelated areas of trade and development, and as the custodian of nine Sustainable Development Goal indicators at the global level, UNCTAD will support the implementation, monitoring and review of the 2030 Agenda and the relevant targets of the Goals, including by continuing to develop international standards and recommending methodologies for monitoring Goal indicators. It will also support the implementation of the Pact for the Future, notably the reform of the international financial architecture, the work on beyond gross domestic product (GDP), interoperable data governance and making the digital economy more inclusive. UNCTAD will also support borrower countries in addressing their debt challenges, exchanging experiences and fostering cooperation to improve their debt management practices, in line with the Sevilla Commitment.
- 12.5 Alongside global agendas, UNCTAD will ensure the implementation of mandates reconfirmed and reinforced at its sixteenth quadrennial session, as outlined in the Geneva Consensus. In particular, UNCTAD will further strengthen its support for the least developed countries through dedicated graduation support; for landlocked and transit developing countries, by supporting the implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034; and for small island developing States, by supporting the implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity, as well as by building on the UNCTAD Strategy to support Small Island Developing States. Moreover, UNCTAD will enhance the capacity of developing countries to participate in e-commerce.
- 12.6 To address the adverse effects of climate change and environmental degradation, which can hinder economic growth, UNCTAD will continue to contribute to new global trade, financial and policy frameworks that more fully integrate inclusiveness, climate change and the environment. This work includes supporting the scaling up of climate finance, using the potential of trade for climate action, reducing greenhouse gas emissions of the logistics of trade and global value chains, boosting sustainable investments and supporting a transition to a low-emission sustainable economy, including through critical minerals needed for renewable energy. UNCTAD will advance the issue of the integrated treatment of development economics in international forums, such as the annual sessions of the Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change or the Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity.
- 12.7 To support its member States in promoting structural transformation, UNCTAD will continue to support developing countries in making more accurate diagnostics, inform policy choices by measuring productive capacities and examine the growing significance of services as a new frontier for structural transformation. UNCTAD will also remain at the forefront of understanding the impact of technological advancements on structural transformation and continue its work to make digitalization a force of inclusivity, including those advancements created by emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence. Given the potential of regional economic integration for structural transformation, UNCTAD will continue to support regional and interregional integration processes, such as the implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area or the Global System of Trade Preferences.
- 12.8 UNCTAD will continue to provide timely and high-quality statistical information and indicators in the interrelated areas of trade and development through its Statistics, Data and Digital Service. It will continue to report on developments relating to the Sustainable Development Goals by providing an update on the evolution of a selection of official indicators and on progress in the development of new concepts and methodologies, including analytical and statistical support in collaboration with other relevant international organizations on redefining development metrics of progress beyond GDP. UNCTAD will strengthen synergies between statistics and information technology to enhance its capacity in data science, artificial intelligence and digital transformation. It will foster a culture of innovation and leverage the advances in digital and emerging technologies to enhance its knowledge products and provide data-driven tools to address development challenges. Furthermore, UNCTAD will support developing countries in building their capacity to collect and compile data and measure progress in sustainable, inclusive and equitable trade, growth and development. It will use data collected and reported by countries of the South within their own frameworks to measure South-South cooperation and inform global debates on development support.

- 12.9 UNCTAD will continue to support countries, through technical cooperation, in building their resilience to economic shocks. It will support countries in building productive capacities related to financing for development, investment, international trade, science and technology and logistics.
- 12.10 With regard to cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, national and local levels, UNCTAD will continue to combine its expertise with the reach and in-country presence of partners. Regionally, UNCTAD will work closely with partner organizations, such as the secretariat of the African Continental Free Trade Area through the UNCTAD Regional Office for Africa, as well as regional economic and business communities and strategic development partners, to foster regional economic integration and growth. UNCTAD will continue to foster cooperation with international financial institutions, multilateral development banks and other relevant intergovernmental and multilateral forums to contribute to international policy debates on trade, investment and finance.
- 12.11 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, UNCTAD will continue to collaborate with resident coordinator offices, including through common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks. It will collaborate with the regional commissions through joint projects and initiatives in areas of trade facilitation, sustainable development and the integration of value chains. UNCTAD will continue to work with the World Trade Organization (WTO) and the International Trade Centre (ITC) in a complementary manner to support developing countries in integrating into and benefiting from the multilateral trading system. UNCTAD will continue to contribute to the Inter-Agency Task Force on Financing for Development and collaborate with relevant United Nations entities in the system to implement the Sevilla Commitment, including co-chairing the working group with the Bretton Woods institutions on the Principles on Promoting Responsible Sovereign Borrowing and Lending, and proposals for their implementation. UNCTAD will support the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on Sustainable Development Goal Indicators and lead the United Nations Inter-Agency Cluster on Trade and Productive Capacity in “delivering as one” operational activities at the country level. UNCTAD will support the implementation of outcomes related to science, technology and innovation of the 2030 Agenda and the Pact for the Future, including the multi-stakeholder working group on data governance. To implement the Pact for the Future, UNCTAD will collaborate with the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) on Beyond GDP, in support of the Secretary-General’s High-level Expert Group on Beyond GDP, and the reform of the international financial architecture, with the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime and the Department of Economic and Social Affairs on illicit financial flows, and with the Statistical Commission of the United Nations on South-South cooperation. In coordination with the United Nations Environment Programme, UNDP and the Climate Action Team, UNCTAD will continue to lead the United Nations Task Force on Critical Energy Transition Minerals.
- 12.12 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
- (a) Up-to-date and accurate economic and financial information and data at the country and regional levels continue to be available and cooperation continues with relevant entities on the production of statistics;
 - (b) Extrabudgetary funding continues to be available for technical cooperation programmes, and conditions and capacities exist in member States to adopt and implement policies and strategies;
 - (c) There is political will to achieve consensus in intergovernmental meetings on matters related to UNCTAD;
 - (d) Member States will provide the necessary support for the implementation of mandated activities at the global, regional and national levels.
- 12.13 UNCTAD will continue to mainstream the cross-cutting issue of gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls in its operational activities, deliverables and results. UNCTAD will strengthen the capacity of member States to design and implement policies and establish institutions, frameworks and/or mechanisms that support women’s economic empowerment, economic security and rights and enhance their economic and digital skills and opportunities. UNCTAD will continue to work on the links between gender equality, women’s and girls’

empowerment and trade and development through its women-focused programmes, and advocate for gender-sensitive policy responses. UNCTAD will continue to analyse the barriers that prevent women from fully participating in and benefiting from trade, including as entrepreneurs.

- 12.14 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy and the Geneva Consensus, UNCTAD will continue its efforts to support disability inclusion in trade or technical cooperation projects. UNCTAD will further advance the work of the Inter-Agency Technical Working Group on Trade and Disability Inclusion established in conjunction with the International Labour Organization, ITC and WTO to integrate and enhance disability inclusion in trade and development agendas. UNCTAD will strive to ensure that all venues and conference facilities are accessible to persons with disabilities.
- 12.15 UNCTAD will also contribute to member States' efforts to support the role of youth in sustainable development. UNCTAD will continue to engage with young people through a dedicated network and flagship events designed to integrate the youth perspective into global trade and development policies.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 12.16 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. In particular, the tables of deliverables reflect updated deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026.
- 12.17 UNCTAD will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs. This includes, among others, any decisions concerning proposals on strengthening collaboration with the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the regional commissions through joint mechanisms and proposals to establish joint knowledge hubs. UNCTAD will jointly explore options for strengthening macroeconomic analysis capacities, with a view to contributing more harmonized analysis and policy support to Member States. UNCTAD will also consider proposals aimed at streamlining support for the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States and strengthening and optimizing organizational arrangements in this regard, as appropriate. Further, UNCTAD will explore, in collaboration with the Department of Economic and Social Affairs, the establishment of joint knowledge hubs, co-led by the best-placed entities, to pool knowledge on key issues spread across United Nations development system entities and link to regional and resident coordinator offices.

Legislative mandates

- 12.18 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

1995 (XIX)	Establishment of the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development as an organ of the General Assembly	73/291	Buenos Aires outcome document of the second High-level United Nations Conference on South-South Cooperation
63/260	Development-related activities	75/229	Promotion of sustainable tourism, including ecotourism, for poverty eradication and environment protection
66/288	The future we want		
69/313	Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development (Addis Ababa Action Agenda)	76/258	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries
70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	76/264 78/317	State of global food insecurity
72/279	Repositioning of the United Nations development system in the context of the quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system	79/1	The Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity The Pact for the Future

Part IV International cooperation for development

79/203	Follow-up to and implementation of the SIDS Accelerated Modalities of Action (SAMOA) Pathway and the Mauritius Strategy for the Further Implementation of the Programme of Action for the Sustainable Development of Small Island Developing States	80/129	Follow-up to and implementation of the outcomes of the International Conferences on Financing for Development
79/217	International migration and development	80/135	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21
79/223	Women in development	80/136	Follow-up to and implementation of the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States: A Renewed Declaration for Resilient Prosperity
79/226	Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system	80/149	Development cooperation with middle-income countries
79/233	Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034	80/150	Follow-up to the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries
79/323	Sevilla Commitment	80/151	Follow-up to the Third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries
80/120	Unilateral economic measures as a means of political and economic coercion against developing countries	80/153	Implementation of the Third United Nations Decade for the Eradication of Poverty (2018–2027)
80/121	International trade and development	80/156	South-South cooperation
80/122	International financial system and development	80/186	Follow-up to the Fourth World Conference on Women and full implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action and the outcome of the twenty-third special session of the General Assembly
80/126	Promotion of international cooperation to combat illicit financial flows and strengthen good practices on assets return to foster sustainable development		
80/128	Promotion of inclusive and effective international tax cooperation at the United Nations		

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2021/30	Open-source technologies for sustainable development	2025/4	Mainstreaming a gender perspective into all policies and programmes in the United Nations system
2022/3	Ensuring that the work in the field of statistics and data is adaptive to the changing statistical and data ecosystem		

United Nations Conference on Trade and Development reports

TD/442, TD/442/Corr.1 and TD/442/Corr.2	Report of the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development on its twelfth session	TD/519/Add.2 and TD/519/Add.2/Corr.1	Nairobi Maafikiano
TD/500/Add.1	Report of the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development on its thirteenth session: the Doha Mandate	TD/541/Add.2	The Bridgetown Covenant
		TD/561/Add.2	The Geneva Consensus

Subprogramme 1 Globalization, interdependence and development

General Assembly resolutions

66/188	Addressing excessive price volatility in food and related financial and commodity markets	79/216	Role of the United Nations in promoting development in the context of globalization and interdependence
77/22	Committee on the Exercise of the Inalienable Rights of the Palestinian People	80/123	External debt sustainability and development
79/141	Assistance to the Palestinian people	80/125	Financial inclusion for sustainable development
79/215	Towards a New International Economic Order		

**Subprogramme 2
Investment and enterprise**

General Assembly resolutions

79/201	Entrepreneurship for sustainable development	80/127	Promoting investments for sustainable development
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**Subprogramme 3
International trade and commodities**

General Assembly resolutions

35/63	Restrictive business practices	78/133	Promoting creative economy for sustainable development
70/186	Consumer protection		
74/198	International Year of Creative Economy for Sustainable Development, 2021	79/314	Our ocean, our future: call for action
		80/4	Necessity of ending the economic, commercial and financial embargo imposed by the United States of America against Cuba
74/216	Implementation of Agenda 21, the Programme for the Further Implementation of Agenda 21 and the outcomes of the World Summit on Sustainable Development and of the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development	80/124	Commodities

**Subprogramme 4
Technology and logistics**

General Assembly resolutions

60/252	World Summit on the Information Society	80/118	Information and communications technologies for sustainable development
69/283	Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015–2030	80/147	Science, technology and innovation for sustainable development
78/148	Strengthening the links between all modes of transport to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals	80/173	Outcome document of the high-level meeting of the General Assembly on the overall review of the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society
79/334	Impact of rapid technological change on the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and targets		

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2015/26	Assessment of the progress made in the implementation of and follow-up to the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society	2025/19	Science, technology and innovation for development
		2025/32	Support to Non-Self-Governing Territories by the specialized agencies and international institutions associated with the United Nations
2025/18	Assessment of the progress made in the implementation of and follow-up to the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society		

**Subprogramme 5
Africa, least developed countries and special programmes**

General Assembly resolutions

67/221	Smooth transition for countries graduating from the list of least developed countries	73/133	Graduation of countries from the least developed country category
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Economic and Social Council resolution

2025/2	Report of the Committee for Development Policy on its twenty-sixth session
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Deliverables

12.19 Table 12.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 12.1

Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	10	7	10	10
1. Conference room paper for the Trade and Development Board	1	1	1	1
2. Report on the follow-up to the major United Nations conferences and summits in the areas of UNCTAD expertise	1	1	1	1
3. Report on matters requiring action by the Trade and Development Board in relation to the sixteenth session of UNCTAD	1	–	1	1
4. Conference room papers and working papers prepared for the Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	4	3	4	4
5. Overview of the external evaluations of UNCTAD programmes and projects	1	1	1	1
6. Report on the external evaluation of an UNCTAD subprogramme	1	–	1	1
7. Review of the technical cooperation activities of UNCTAD and their financing	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	111	112	107	107
Meetings of:				
8. The Trade and Development Board, including annual, special and executive sessions of the Board and its subsidiary bodies	88	90	92	92
9. The Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	12	10	12	12
10. The Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	2	1	1
11. The Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
12. The Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
13. The sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD	8	8	–	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	1	2
14. On statistics related to trade and development	1	1	1 [2]	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	28	24	24	17
15. Seminars on topics to be determined by the Secretary-General of UNCTAD, in consultation with member States	3	3	3	3
16. Seminars, including with civil society and member States, to generate and transfer knowledge in connection with the work programme of UNCTAD	2	2	2	2
17. Seminar on topical trade and development issues	1	–	1	–
18. Seminar on topical international trade and development issues	1	–	1	–
19. Seminars to advance the trade and development agenda through international cooperation	2	1	2	–
20. Seminar on the coordination of national development strategies oriented towards sustainable development	1	1	1	1
21. Workshops with academia, civil society and youth	18	17	14	11
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	3	3
22. <i>UNCTAD Handbook of Statistics</i>	1	1	1	1
23. <i>SDG Pulse</i>	1	1	1	1
24. UNCTAD annual report	1	1	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
Technical materials (number of materials)	11	10	10	8
25. Policy briefs on trade and development issues	2	2	2	–
26. Reports on independent evaluations (including reports on evaluations of United Nations Development Account projects)	5	4	5	4
27. Economic and maritime statistical country profiles	2	2	2	2
28. Statistical papers, including on international trade and development	2	2	1 [2]	2

C. Substantive deliverables

Databases and substantive digital materials: UNCTAD statistical data centre; UNCTAD Data Insights, complementing the *Handbook of Statistics* with a live statistical feed; UNCTAD trade-in-services statistics information system; UNCTAD global data set of indicators on gender equality in trade; UNCTAD civil society database and civil society electronic alerts and UNCTAD Youth Network.

Consultation, advice and advocacy: policy advice to policymakers for statistical capacity in the area of trade and development.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: integrated marketing strategy through a client relationship management tool and strategic outreach programme; “UNCTAD at a Glance”; press kits, media briefs and flyers for flagship publications; news briefs and opinion pieces; public information materials, including brochures and posters; and at least 10 specialized information sessions for media students, delegates, academics and youth visiting UNCTAD and, upon request, in other locations, including online outreach.

External and media relations: around 10 press conferences, 25 press releases in all six official United Nations languages, 30 media alerts and information notes.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: UNCTAD website and social media content, including podcasts and blogs about UNCTAD meetings, events and publications, including policy briefs; UNCTAD digital monthly newsletter; UNCTAD Data Hub, showcasing UNCTAD data and statistics.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 12).

Evaluation activities

- 12.20 The following evaluations conducted by UNCTAD and completed in 2025 have guided the proposed programme plan for 2027:
 - (a) UNCTAD e-commerce and digital economy programme;
 - (b) Three evaluations of projects related to trade, transport and economic development issues.
- 12.21 In response to the results of the evaluations referenced above, UNCTAD has made efforts to strengthen sustainability planning, improve project management practices, deepen partnerships with resident coordinator offices, enhance the targeted dissemination of research products and continue to mainstream a gender perspective, disability inclusion and environmental considerations in its work. The eTrade Reform Tracker, for example, will sustain outcomes by clarifying responsibilities, enhancing transparency and supporting structured follow-up on e-trade readiness actions.
- 12.22 The following evaluations to be conducted by UNCTAD are planned for 2027:
 - (a) Evaluation of subprogramme 5, Africa, least developed countries and special programmes;
 - (b) Four project evaluations.

Programme of work

Subprogramme 1

Globalization, interdependence and development

Objective

- 12.23 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance inclusive and sustainable development, sustained growth, full employment and decent work for all through evidence-based economic policies and strategies at the national, regional and international levels and to achieve progress towards durable solutions on debt, economic resilience and poverty eradication in developing countries, especially the least developed countries, including through North-South cooperation, complemented but not substituted by South-South and triangular cooperation.

Strategy

- 12.24 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will identify specific needs and measures arising from the interdependence of trade, finance, investment, technology and macroeconomic policies, from the point of view of their effects on development, through the three pillars of work of UNCTAD referred to in paragraph 12.2 above. Specifically, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support developing countries in promoting structural economic transformation through statistics, capacity-building and technical cooperation, identify policy options, design industrial and productive transformation strategies and foster regional and cross-regional partnerships for sustainable growth;
 - (b) Support developing countries in the realization of the 2030 Agenda by fostering a more inclusive and resilient global economy and by enhancing the efficiency of the global economic system, international trade and debt sustainability;
 - (c) Undertake analytical and technical work on debt issues – fostering debt-management practices, promoting responsible borrowing and lending practices, supporting exchanges among borrower countries on debt challenges, and contributing to global debt data transparency and harmonization;
 - (d) Support countries in identifying policy options to scale up domestic resources and strengthen international resource mobilization;
 - (e) Support countries in engaging in discussions on reforming the international financial architecture, multilateral development banks and credit rating agencies, by providing them with relevant analyses and information;
 - (f) Conduct analytical work on assessing the role of official development assistance as a key component of financing for development, including in mobilizing additional public and private finance and the role of such assistance in international net financial flows, both North-South and South-North;
 - (g) Undertake research and analysis on the trends of the global economy and prospects for closer cooperation and integration among developing countries to inform their development strategies, including by promoting dialogue and best practice among existing regionally integrated structures;
 - (h) Provide technical assistance and research and analysis to support the Palestinian people, in line with paragraphs 80.68 and 80.69 of the Geneva Consensus and responding to the request of the General Assembly in its resolutions [77/22](#) on the Committee on the Exercise of the Inalienable Rights of the Palestinian People and [79/141](#) on assistance to the Palestinian people;

- (i) Conduct analytical work on climate finance and sustainable development to assist developing countries in leveraging financial resources to address vulnerabilities, with the aim of building productive capacities resilient to extreme weather events exacerbated by climate change.
- 12.25 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Increased coherence between international economic rules, practices and processes and national policies and development strategies;
 - (b) Improved mobilization of domestic financial resources as well as international resources, including through South-South cooperation;
 - (c) More effective debt management and a shared understanding at the international level of debt issues and debt sustainability, and facilitated exchanges among borrowing countries;
 - (d) Increased understanding by developing countries of the global economic environment and of policy choices for inclusive and sustained development;
 - (e) Trade and development policies that are responsive to the challenges posed by climate change and the type of support and action needed.

Programme performance in 2025

Trade and Development Foresights informs global policy discussions and responses

- 12.26 In 2025, to adapt to the rapidly changing global economic environment and to better align the subprogramme's research with the needs of policymakers in developing countries, the subprogramme released a newly restructured *Trade and Development Foresights 2025*, which highlighted emerging risks – especially for countries that are highly vulnerable to external shocks – and outlined policy priorities to strengthen resilience in a global economy facing persistent challenges. The analysis equipped policymakers and informed international policy discussions, contributing to financial policy debates in global policy forums and elevating the perspectives of developing countries.
- 12.27 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.2).

Table 12.2
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
Discussions at the International Monetary Fund-World Bank Spring Meetings on financial vulnerabilities and debt and development distress considering the needs of developing countries were informed by the <i>Trade and Development Report 2023</i>	The priority set by the Brazilian presidency of the Group of 20, of reducing inequality through macroeconomic policy, was informed by the Group of 20-commissioned report prepared by UNCTAD in support of the work relating to the first priority of the Group of 20 Framework Working Group	The Group of 20 concept note by the South African presidency, the political declaration and related outcomes of the meeting of Group of 20 Development Ministers, the political declaration of the BRICS member States in Brazil and the “1+10” dialogue in China with heads of major international economic organizations were informed by <i>Trade and Development Foresights 2025</i>

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: enhanced debt data transparency of developing countries

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.28 The subprogramme's work contributed to improved reporting by Ecuador, Egypt and Jordan of debt data to public and international institutions, including submission to the World Bank Quarterly External Debt Statistics database, which met the planned target.
- 12.29 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.3).

Table 12.3
Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Informal discussions and consultations resulting in at least three countries expressing interest in being involved in the pilot initiative	Enhanced understanding by 16 developing countries of the interlinkages between debt data transparency and the role of credit rating agencies, including their data requirements	Improved reporting by Ecuador, Egypt and Jordan of debt data to public and international institutions, including submission to the World Bank Quarterly External Debt Statistics database	Improved interactions between at least three developing countries and credit rating agencies	Three developing countries expand coverage of their debt bulletin

Result 2: developing economies design sustainable industrial and structural transformation policies through South-South and triangular cooperation

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.30 The subprogramme's work contributed to enhanced capacity in Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Pakistan and Türkiye to design and implement integrated policies for sustainable transformation and industrialization, which met the planned target. The subprogramme's work also contributed to initial discussions on building a partnership network, which did not meet the planned target of establishing a regional network used regularly by policymakers from at least four countries in Asia to strengthen South-South cooperation on sustainable industrialization. The target was not met because follow-up activities aimed at developing an online platform and agreeing on terms of reference beyond the initial participant countries did not take place owing to liquidity-related constraints.
- 12.31 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.4).

Table 12.4
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Capacity gaps and binding constraints for sustainable industrialization policies identified in Pakistan	Capacity gaps and binding constraints for sustainable industrialization policies identified in Kazakhstan and Malaysia	Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Pakistan and Türkiye enhanced their capacity to design and implement integrated policies for sustainable transformation and industrialization	A regional South-South policy platform is established in Latin America to facilitate peer-to-peer policy coordination, synergies and learning on sustainable industrialization At least four countries in Africa join South-South cooperation platforms on sustainable industrialization in Asia and Latin America	Enhanced capacities in at least four developing economies in Latin America and two in Africa to design and implement sustainable industrial policies for structural transformation and advanced regional cooperation

Result 3: borrower countries manage debt in a more efficient and sustainable way**Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 12.32 Today, approximately 3.4 billion people live in countries that spend more on servicing their public debt than on either health or education.¹ The Debt Management and Financial Analysis System, aimed at helping Member States to sustainably manage their debt, is currently used in over 60 countries. To further increase debt management capacity, UNCTAD has been convening meetings to support borrowing countries since 2023.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 12.33 The lesson for the subprogramme was that there was an increased need to support countries using the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System, particularly through new functionalities, in order to respond to the evolving nature of debt markets and the rising significance of private creditors relative to official creditors, which has added new transparency and data-quality requirements for borrower countries. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will help countries to adopt a new version of the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System, tailored to meet the additional requirements, and will focus on providing a permanent platform for coordination and knowledge-sharing. Furthermore, the subprogramme will support the establishment of the borrowers' platform mandated by the Sevilla Commitment to help to increase cooperation, share experiences, build capacities and coordinate approaches to managing debt.
- 12.34 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.5)

¹ UNCTAD, *A World of Debt Report 2025: It is Time for Reform* (Geneva, 2025).

Table 12.5
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Three developing countries adopted and used version 7 of the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System and its expanded functionalities to manage their debt	At least 10 developing countries adopt the advanced functionalities of version 7 of the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System The borrowers' platform for knowledge-sharing and peer learning is launched, with at least 10 borrowing countries sharing lessons and experiences	An additional eight developing countries adopt the advanced functionalities of version 7 of the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System The membership of the borrowers' platform grows to at least 12 borrowing countries, and at least two peer-learning exchanges take place

Deliverables

12.35 Table 12.6 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 12.6
Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	7	6	6	5
1. Reports for the General Assembly, including on external debt sustainability and development and the economic cost of occupation for the Palestinian people	2	2	2	2
2. Reports for the Trade and Development Board, including on financing for development issues and on UNCTAD assistance to the Palestinian people	2	2	2	2
3. Reports for the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD	1	–	–	–
4. Reports for the Trade and Development Commission and the Investment, Enterprise and Development Commission	1	1	1	–
5. Reports for the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Financing for Development	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	30	29	19	19
Meetings of:				
6. The General Assembly (Second Committee) and the Economic and Social Council and its subsidiary bodies	4	1	4	4
7. The Trade and Development Board	3	3	3	3
8. The Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	2	2	2	2
9. The sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD, including preparatory meetings	12	12	–	–
10. The Trade and Development Commission and related multi-year expert meetings	3	–	4 [6]	4

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
11. The Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Financing for Development	6	6	– [6]	6
12. The Debt Management Conference	–	5	6	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	16	15	11	11
13. Enhancing public, private and/or international capacity related to assistance to the Palestinian people	1	–	1	1
14. Installation, update and maintenance of the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System	15	15	10	10
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	142	139	162	162
15. Seminars and workshops for policymakers, including on formulating development strategies and policy recommendations; sovereign borrowing and lending; and globalization, trade and development	22	23	20	20
16. Seminars on inclusive growth and the Sustainable Development Goals, including ad hoc expert discussions on the interdependence between trade, finance, investment, technology and macroeconomic policies	5	1	2	2
17. Training events on the Debt Management and Financial Analysis System for administrators and debt auditors from selected countries in recording debt data, reporting, debt statistics, debt analysis and debt auditing	115	115	140	140
Publications (number of publications)	6	7	5	5
18. <i>Trade and Development Report</i> and its overview	1	2	2	2
19. Studies on external debt, resource mobilization, South-South cooperation, regional integration and Palestinian economic development	5	5	3	3
Technical materials (number of materials)	7	8	8	8
20. On macroeconomic, development, financing and debt, climate financing, structural transformation and South-South cooperation issues	4	3	3 [5]	3
21. Debt Management and Financial Analysis System documentation and software	3	5	5	5
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: policy advice to policymakers, including on domestic resource mobilization, structural transformation, macroeconomic policies (Group of 20), debt renegotiation at the Paris Club, financial instability and debt sustainability.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: lectures and presentations on external debt, development finance and macroeconomic and development policy issues.				
External and media relations: press releases, press conferences and interviews, including on developing country debt and external financing, South-South cooperation and regional integration and assistance to the Palestinian people.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: Debt Management and Financial Analysis System.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 12).

Subprogramme 2 Investment and enterprise

Objective

- 12.36 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance inclusive growth and sustainable development through investment and enterprise development for productive capacity-building, economic diversification and job creation.

Strategy

12.37 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:

- (a) Assist member States through research, policy analysis and technical assistance in designing and implementing policies to scale up mobilization of public and private finance and enhanced investment and entrepreneurship for sustainable development;
- (b) Monitor, assess and analyse regional and global trends and prospects in international investment and prepare the annual *World Investment Report* and other analytical publications on international investment for development;
- (c) Promote policy frameworks that create an enabling environment at all levels in support of developing countries to better attract, increase and facilitate investments for the achievement of sustainable development;
- (d) Conduct reviews of national investment policies and backstop policy dialogue on the international investment regime and support and design new international investment agreements that are better aligned with nationally and internationally agreed development objectives;
- (e) Provide policy advice to Governments on investment promotion, including on incentives in the context of the global tax reform implications for developing countries, and support with the implementation of business practices and investment facilitation for development agreements, including through digital government tools;
- (f) Promote innovative financing for the Sustainable Development Goals, including through stock exchanges and institutional funds, as well as incentives in the context of the global tax reform implications for developing countries;
- (g) Support enhancement of the international competitiveness of member States' enterprises through advice on policies aimed at stimulating enterprise development, including mobilizing global efforts in financing and investment in micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises to support their sustainable development transformation, as well as by promoting best practices in corporate social responsibility, accounting and sustainability reporting;
- (h) Foster dialogue and an exchange of best practices related to investment and enterprise development issues through consensus-building mechanisms and the World Investment Forum;
- (i) Provide an assessment of the impact of multiple and cascading challenges on investment, global value chains and enterprise development, as well as policy advice, frameworks and tools for recovery.

12.38 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Increased capacity of member States to close the gaps related to Sustainable Development Goal investment, especially with regard to climate change mitigation and adaptation, in particular for countries that are most vulnerable to the adverse impacts of climate change;
- (b) Improved ability of countries to leverage policies, innovations and tools, and to address key and emerging issues related to investment and investment policies that promote development, including policies on international investment agreements and on the opportunities of remittances and diaspora investment for development;
- (c) Member States collecting, analysing and reporting on foreign direct investment and multinational enterprise data and formulating development-oriented investment policies;
- (d) Additional resources leveraged and channelled towards global investment development objectives and addressing concerns pertaining to "SDG washing" and "greenwashing";²

² The terms "SDG washing" and "greenwashing" refer to products and strategies presented as sustainable without making a meaningful contribution to sustainable development, including the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.

- (e) Increased productive capacity, including through attracting investment capital, growing business linkages with multinational enterprises and participating in global and regional value chains;
- (f) Mitigation of the effect of multiple and cascading challenges on the ability of member States to attract and benefit from investment for development and to foster private sector recovery;
- (g) Progress by member States towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 4, 5, 8, 9, 10, 12, 13, 16 and 17.

Programme performance in 2025

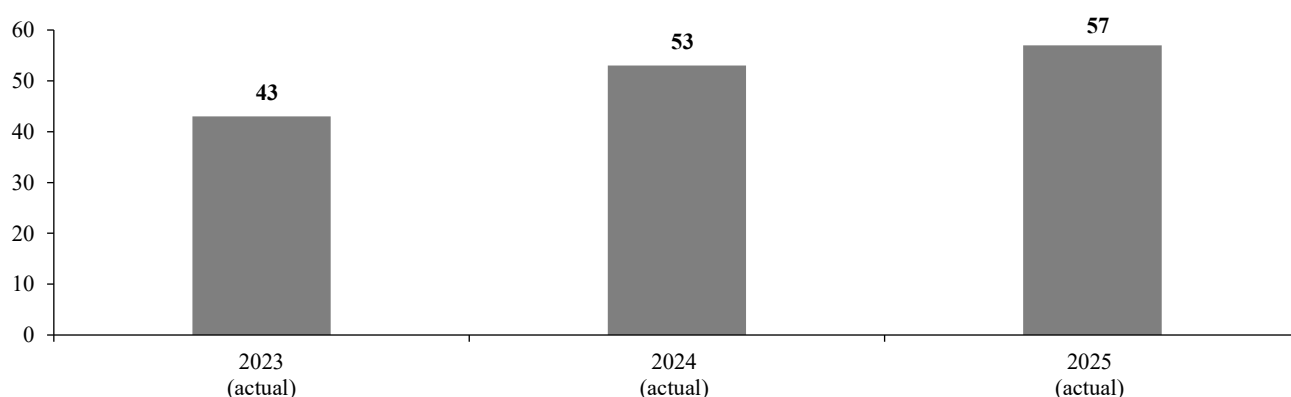
Strengthened entrepreneurship ecosystems for inclusive and innovative enterprise development

12.39 Entrepreneurship can be a driver of productive transformation, yet structural constraints often hinder micro- and small enterprises in many developing countries from growing, innovating and integrating into national, regional and global value chains. To help to build more dynamic and sustainable entrepreneurship ecosystems for inclusive and innovative enterprise development, the subprogramme has strengthened its policy guidance, capacity-building and advisory support for member States. This includes the provision of entrepreneurship-related recommendations from investment policy reviews, targeted analysis and advisory services delivered through the Entrepreneurship Policy Framework, and the expansion of the UNCTAD Entrepreneurship Development Programme (EMPRETEC) to a growing number of beneficiary countries to reinforce entrepreneurial skills and enterprise support systems.

12.40 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.I).

Figure 12.I

Performance measure: number of member States implementing recommendations stemming from UNCTAD work on entrepreneurship (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

Result 1: accelerated Sustainable Development Goal investment

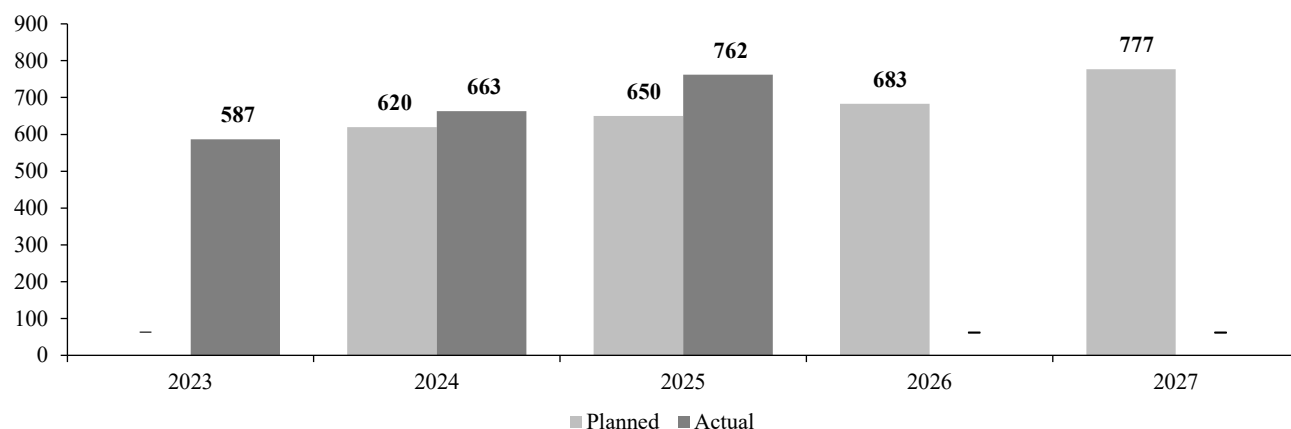
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

12.41 The subprogramme's work contributed to 762 investment-development stakeholders adopting recommendations from the set of priority actions identified by UNCTAD to accelerate investment in the Sustainable Development Goals, such as the reorientation of investment promotion strategies, the establishment of global partnerships for sustainable investment, the formulation of a new generation of international investment treaties and guarantees, enhanced regional and South-South investment partnerships, innovative financing mechanisms and the reorientation of financial markets, which exceeded the planned target of 650 investment-development stakeholders.

- 12.42 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.II).

Figure 12.II

Performance measure: number of investment-development stakeholders that have adopted recommendations from the set of priority actions to accelerate investment in the Sustainable Development Goals (cumulative)



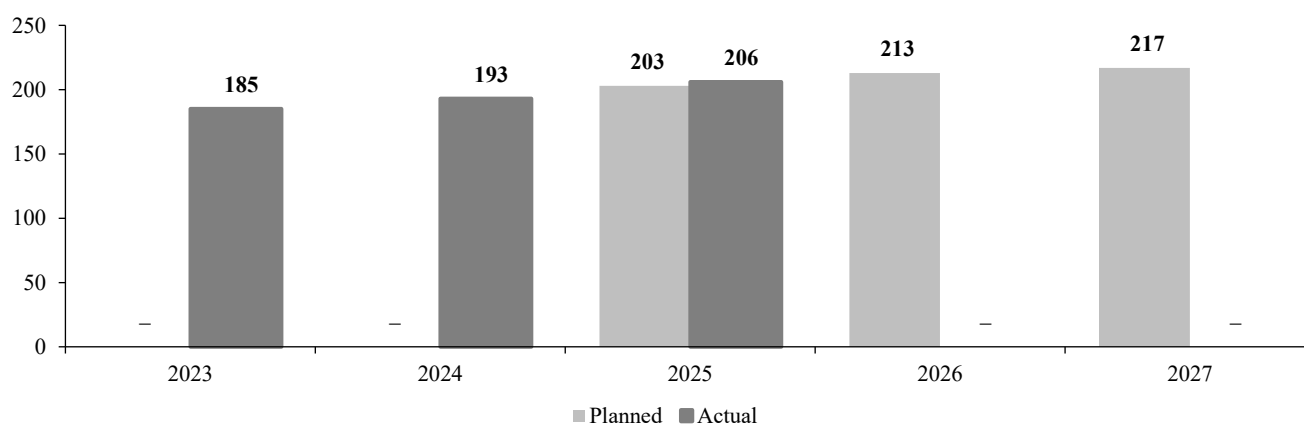
Result 2: member States foster conducive business and investment climate

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.43 The subprogramme's work contributed to 206 UNCTAD instruments being adopted by member States in support of a better business environment, including in the promotion and facilitation of investment for development, the adoption of digital tools to facilitate the provision of investment-related information, and the streamlining of administrative processes and procedures related to business, which exceeded the planned target of 203 instruments.
- 12.44 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.III).

Figure 12.III

Performance measure: number of instruments adopted by member States in support of a better business environment (cumulative)



Result 3: increased adoption of sustainable investment practices

Proposed programme plan for 2027

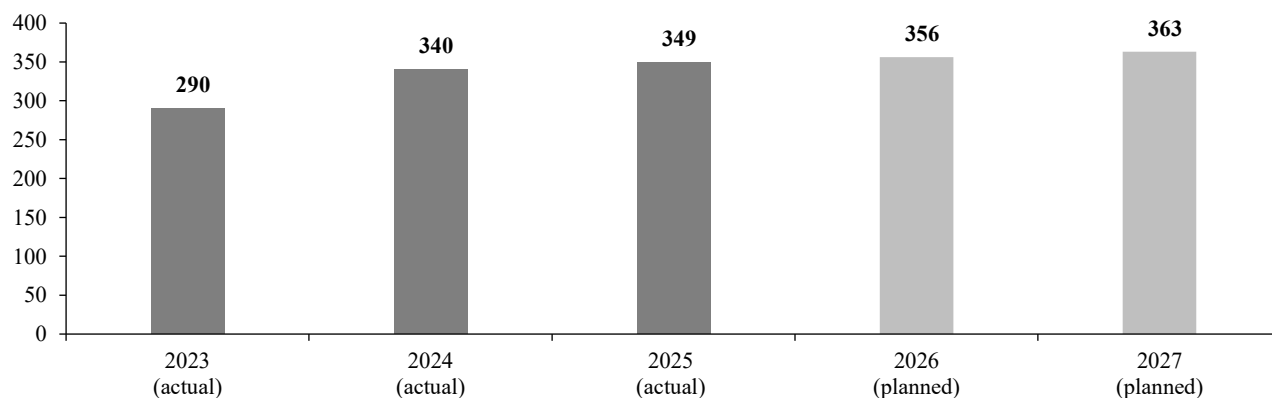
- 12.45 Sustainable investment practices help to align global capital flows with the Sustainable Development Goals, yet many markets face challenges related to transparency, comparability and the effective implementation of sustainability standards. To support countries in strengthening the sustainable development impact of investment flows, the subprogramme has expanded its policy guidance, analytical tools and multi-stakeholder platforms aimed at improving sustainability practices in capital markets, such as the Sustainable Stock Exchanges Initiative, the Global Sustainable Finance Observatory and regional partnerships for the promotion of sustainability reporting.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 12.46 The lesson for the subprogramme was the importance of strengthening UNCTAD support for effective de-risking strategies to help channel investment and finance towards the Goals, particularly in developing countries where perceived and real risks can often constrain capital flows. In applying this lesson, the subprogramme will place emphasis on de-risking support by promoting transparency, strengthening sustainability reporting, supporting coherent regulatory approaches and helping countries to adopt practices that reduce information asymmetries and lower investor uncertainty. To do so, the subprogramme will leverage and integrate the tools and platforms it has developed, while also enhancing its broader support to countries on risk-sharing instruments and blended finance.
- 12.47 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.IV).

Figure 12.IV

Performance measure: number of stakeholders using tools developed by UNCTAD in support of sustainable investment practices (cumulative)



Deliverables

- 12.48 Table 12.7 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 12.7

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^a</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	8	7	6	6
Reports of:				
1. The Secretary-General to the General Assembly on investment and entrepreneurship for sustainable development	1	1	2	1
2. The sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD on investment and enterprise for development	1	1	–	–
3. The Trade and Development Board on investment for development	1	1	– [1]	1
4. The Investment, Enterprise and Development Commission and related expert meetings	3	1	2 [3]	1
5. The Intergovernmental Working Group of Experts on International Standards of Accounting and Reporting	2	3	2	3
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	58	34	18	18
Meetings of:				
6. The Trade and Development Board	2	1	2	2
7. The sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD, including preparatory meetings	20	20	–	–
8. The Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	2	2	2	2
9. The Investment, Enterprise and Development Commission and related expert meetings	8	5	8	8
10. The Intergovernmental Working Group of Experts on International Standards of Accounting and Reporting	6	6	6	6
11. The World Investment Forum	20	–	–	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	67	49	45	35
12. On regional investment issues	3	3	3 [4]	2
13. On investment policy reviews	6	3	4 [5]	3
14. On policy options in investment for development, including public-private partnerships	4	3	1 [2]	1
15. On special economic zones, including piloting Sustainable Development Goals model zones	2	1	1	1
16. On international investment regimes	10	7	6 [8]	4
17. On investment promotion and facilitation, including investment-ready and impactful Sustainable Development Goal projects	3	2	2	1
18. On business facilitation initiatives, including digital government solutions	12	12	10 [12]	10
19. On enterprise development initiatives, including micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises and start-up financing and business linkages, with a focus on women- and youth-owned micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises	3	3	2	1
20. On the Entrepreneurship Development Programme (EMPRETEC), including financial technology (fintech) and technology-related education programmes	10	6	5 [8]	3
21. On accounting and reporting, with a particular focus on sustainability reporting	3	3	2 [3]	2
22. On the contribution of foreign direct investment to inclusive growth and the Sustainable Development Goals, including on climate change mitigation and adaptation for least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States	6	1	5 [6]	4
23. On sustainable financing and investing, including impact investing, and initiatives of the Sustainable Stock Exchanges Initiative, including stock exchange trade initiatives	5	5	4 [5]	3

Section 12 Trade and development

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	199	191	174	174
24. On foreign direct investment, its development dimension and the themes of the <i>World Investment Report</i>	12	9	10 [12]	10
25. On best practices in national and international policies related to investment, including best practices in taxation related to investment policy, the sustainable energy transition, investment in the digital economy, infrastructure and industrial development, and remittances	5	1	3 [5]	3
26. On investment policy reviews, follow-up and investment facilitation enhancement (national)	14	14	10 [14]	10
27. On international investment statistics and survey methodologies	5	2	3 [5]	3
28. On key issues in investment for development, including concerns about “greenwashing” and “SDG washing”, and de-risking mechanisms for investment	4	6	6	6
29. On investment promotion and facilitation for policymakers, investment promotion officials and diplomats	10	8.5	6 [8]	6
30. On business facilitation procedures	20	60	20 [22]	30
31. On the negotiation, implementation and reform of international investment agreements	15	12.5	13 [15]	13
32. On investment policies for sustainable development, including public-private partnerships in support of Sustainable Development Goal financing sectors	6	4.5	6	5
33. On enterprise development policies and entrepreneurship, including leveraging sustainable technology	40	37.5	30 [35]	30
34. On the development of youth entrepreneurship for sustainable development	–	–	5	5
35. On accounting and sustainability reporting, including climate-related disclosures	20	13	20	18
36. On responsible investment issues, including those related to intellectual property and impact investment	35	18.5	31 [35]	27
37. On the development of small and medium-sized enterprises and start-ups	6	1	6	4
38. On institutional investors and sustainable development	4	2.5	4	3
39. On family businesses and offices in support of financing Sustainable Development Goal sectors	3	1	1 [3]	1
Publications (number of publications)	18	13	12	12
40. <i>World Investment Report</i> and its overview	2	2	2	2
41. On investment issues for development, including best practices in foreign direct investment in the least developed countries, and studies on responsible and sustainable investment	6	5	4 [5]	4
42. On investment policies for development, including <i>Investment Policy Reviews</i> and studies on policy options on investment for development	5	5	3 [4]	3
43. On investment promotion and facilitation, including on investing in Sustainable Development Goal sectors and Sustainable Development Goal model zones development	2	–	2	2
44. On enterprise competitiveness	2	1	1	1
45. On the International Standards of Accounting and Reporting	1	–	– [1]	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	16	15	10	10
46. <i>Global Investment Trends Monitor</i> , including the <i>Sustainable Development Goals Investment Trends Monitor</i>	3	2	2 [3]	2
47. <i>Global Investment Policy Monitor</i>	3	3	2	2
48. Investment promotion and facilitation with a focus on Sustainable Development Goal-related sectors	2	–	1 [2]	1
49. On measures affecting international investment	2	1	1 [2]	1
50. International investment agreement issues notes	3	3	1 [3]	1
51. On responsible investment for sustainable development	2	5	2	2
52. On enterprise development and entrepreneurship policy support	1	1	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
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C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: policy advice to developing countries, including on policies to attract foreign direct investment; advice on statistics and international investment, including responsible investment; advice to all member States, upon request, on national policies and international investment agreements and sustainable development, investment promotion and facilitation, entrepreneurship and enterprise development and business facilitation, with a focus on the most vulnerable, and on accounting and reporting standards; and advocacy and advisory services to some 200 investment promotion agencies, over 5,000 special economic zones and other stakeholders in the global investment chain and some 50 EMPRETEC centres.

Databases and substantive digital materials: databases on foreign direct investment, national policies, international investment agreements and related databases; sustainable finance and gender equality databases.

D. Communication deliverables

External and media relations: electronic EMPRETEC newsletters for more than 2,000 subscribers and newsletters, booklets and newsflashes on responsible investment; World Investment Forum report for more than 8,000 recipients; development and maintenance of the World Investment Network of over 18,000 recipients.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: Global Enterprise Registration portal; Investment Policy Hub; other digital platforms pertaining to investment and enterprise for development.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 12).

Subprogramme 3 International trade and commodities

Objective

- 12.49 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to ensure that international trade and commodities enable the economic diversification, sustainable and resilient economy and multilateralism transformations needed to create a more inclusive, resilient, sustainable and prosperous world through the participation of all member States.

Strategy

- 12.50 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Support developing countries in fostering structural transformation through economic diversification towards a more sustainable and resilient economy;
 - (b) Enhance the participation of developing countries in the multilateral and regional trading systems, ensuring that developing countries' participation in trade in goods and services at all levels of the value chain, including through broader UNCTAD support for the analysis and utilization of the relevant data, works as a driver for inclusive and sustainable development;
 - (c) Support the adoption of, improvement in and enforcement of national and regional competition and consumer protection legislation, through best practices, guidelines and peer reviews;
 - (d) Strengthen the capacity of trade policymakers to make well-informed policy decisions through improved understanding of and transparency in international trade and trade policy trends and trade-related regulations, and build private sector capacities to cope with policy and market requirements;
 - (e) Foster the mainstreaming of gender equality and disability inclusion into trade policies and build the capacity of member States through research findings, training workshops and policy dialogues to design and implement trade policies that allow women and persons with disabilities to benefit more from the opportunities arising from international trade;

- (f) Contribute to research on international trade as an engine for development in the report of the Inter-Agency Task Force on Financing for Development, *The Sustainable Development Goals Report*, *World Tariff Profiles* and *World Economic Situation and Prospects*;
- (g) Bearing in mind the current challenging global context, as described in paragraphs 12, 13, 18 and 19 of the Geneva Consensus, monitor and report on current trade measures, trends and policies and their impact on inclusive, sustainable and resilient development to provide policy recommendations to member States;
- (h) Examine the effects of climate change in terms of trade on developing countries, and how environmental sustainability can promote global trade and inclusive development, including through trade policies facilitating global energy transition and supporting the competitiveness of developing countries in the production and trade of renewable and low-emission energy;
- (i) Support member States, through research, capacity-building activities and the fostering of policy dialogue, in their efforts to break away from commodity dependence and realize trade and economic diversification gains, including for critical minerals, by adding value to their commodities and strengthening non-commodity activities.

12.51 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Enhanced understanding and policy response regarding current trends in the global economy, including ongoing environmental degradation, and improved ability of member States to benefit from international trade and foster the recovery of the trade sectors;
- (b) Member States designing and implementing trade-policy responses to climate change from a development perspective;
- (c) Member States identifying and addressing trade barriers and supply-side obstacles that disproportionately affect women and girls, and persons with disabilities;
- (d) Member States and the international community understanding and addressing the cost and market access impacts of non-tariff measures, as well as their beneficial use for inclusive and sustainable development policies;
- (e) Member States achieving positive development outcomes in relation to increased trade integration and activity;
- (f) Member States seizing opportunities emerging from commodity trade and enhanced international and regional cooperation;
- (g) Member States' increased adoption, revision and/or effective implementation of competition and consumer protection legislation and institutional frameworks;
- (h) Member States harnessing opportunities related to trade in environmentally sustainable products, and increasing capacities to assess the economic potential of the ocean, biodiversity and plastic substitutes-related sectors, and devising integrated sustainable use and trade action plans;
- (i) Member States creating an enabling environment for the promotion of services and the creative economy to leapfrog into new, high-growth sectors of the world economy;
- (j) Progress by member States towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 9, 12, 13, 14 and 17.

Programme performance in 2025

Enhanced consumer product safety

- 12.52 UNCTAD data indicate that approximately 40 per cent of member States have reported having product safety legislation,³ highlighting the potential for strengthening regulatory frameworks and fostering global alignment through increased coherence, comparability and mutual recognition of product safety regimes. As the focal point for consumer protection within the United Nations system, the subprogramme promotes the implementation of the United Nations guidelines for consumer protection by undertaking analysis, supporting countries in designing and implementing effective consumer policies and providing a forum for intergovernmental deliberations. To improve consumer product safety globally, and driven by the subprogramme's long-standing work and consensus-building under its Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Consumer Protection Law and Policy, member States adopted the United Nations principles for consumer product safety at the Ninth United Nations Conference to Review All Aspects of the Set of Multilaterally Agreed Equitable Principles and Rules for the Control of Restrictive Business Practices,⁴ held in July 2025. These principles provide the first globally agreed blueprint for modern product safety frameworks.
- 12.53 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.8).

Table 12.8
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	United Nations principles for consumer product safety were adopted by the Ninth United Nations Conference to Review All Aspects of the Set of Multilaterally Agreed Equitable Principles and Rules for the Control of Restrictive Business Practices Member States of the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa adopted its Competition and Consumer Protection Regulations and Rules, which are aligned with the United Nations principles for consumer product safety

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: strengthened implementation of nationally determined contributions through trade policies by developing countries

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.54 The subprogramme's work contributed to the Gambia increasing the integration of trade policies in its nationally determined contributions and 240 decision makers and stakeholders increasing their capacities in trade and development policy, which exceeded the planned target of at least one pilot

³ See <https://unctad.org/topic/competition-and-consumer-protection/consumer-protection-map>.

⁴ To be renamed as the Conference on Competition and Consumer Protection, with the tenth session of this Conference being convened in 2030 (see General Assembly resolution 80/121, para. 43).

country increasing the integration of trade policies in its nationally determined contributions, and the trade and development policy capacities of 100 decision makers and stakeholders being increased.

- 12.55 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.9).

Table 12.9
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Preliminary mapping of trade-related measures in nationally determined contributions, and a pilot analysis on fishing fleets and the energy transition, were available to member States	Recommendations on trade-related measures for reducing greenhouse gas emissions in nationally determined contributions made available to member States A framework for the increased use of trade measures in nationally determined contributions made available to member States	The Gambia increased the integration of trade policies in its nationally determined contributions Trade and development policy capacity of 240 decision makers and stakeholders increased	At least two pilot countries increase the integration of trade policies in their nationally determined contributions Trade and development policy capacity of 200 decision makers and stakeholders is increased	Member States have access to analysis and lessons learned from developing countries in integrating trade policies into nationally determined contributions Trade and development policy capacity of 200 decision makers and stakeholders is increased

Result 2: member States harness critical energy transition minerals for sustainable development

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.56 The subprogramme's work contributed to Namibia and Zambia adopting policies for harnessing critical energy transition minerals for sustainable development, which met the planned target.
- 12.57 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.10).

Table 12.10
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Critical energy transition minerals issues were further advanced through the adoption by the General Assembly of resolution 78/138 on commodities	Member States have access to principles and recommendations on benefit-sharing, value addition and economic diversification through the report issued by the United	Namibia and Zambia adopted policies for harnessing critical energy transition minerals for sustainable development	At least two additional countries adopt, revise or implement policies for harnessing critical energy transition minerals for sustainable development	At least two additional countries adopt, revise or implement policies for harnessing critical energy transition minerals for sustainable development

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
	Nations Secretary-General's Panel on Critical Energy Transition Minerals			

Result 3: timely non-tariff measures data for better regulatory practices and economic development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

12.58 Non-tariff measures can affect international trade by increasing compliance costs, making it more expensive for businesses, and can create significant obstacles to trade. Non-tariff measures are inherently complex and encompass a wide range of regulatory measures, including product requirements, health and safety regulations and import quotas, whose trade effects are not easily measurable. Due to this complexity and diversity, the timely availability of data on such measures can help to avoid high compliance costs for member States. The subprogramme has been leading the effort for global transparency in non-tariff measures by collecting and disseminating related data systematically, enabling a better understanding by policymakers and traders, especially from developing countries.

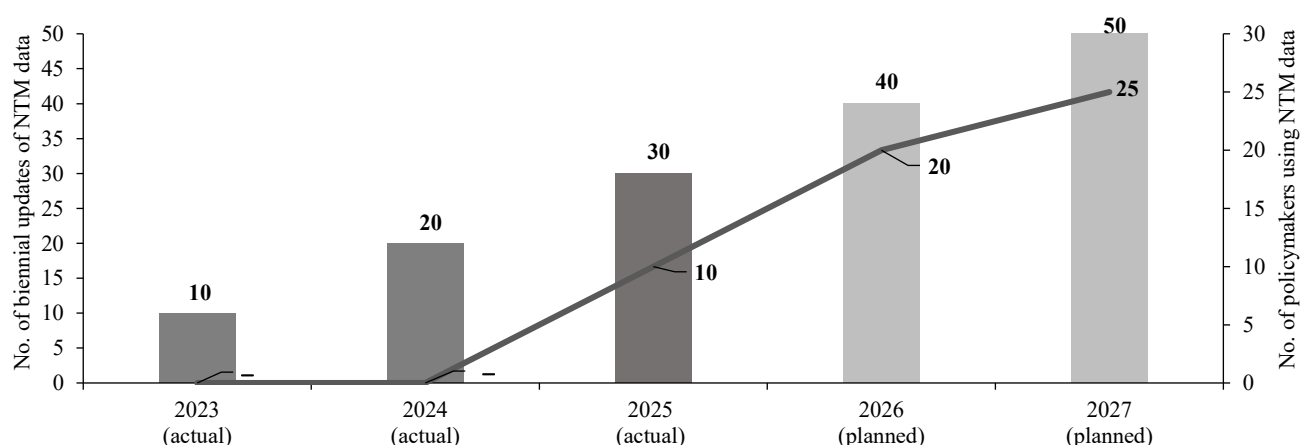
Lessons learned and planned change

12.59 The lesson for the subprogramme was the importance of improving the accessibility and timeliness of data related to non-tariff measures to facilitate analysis by policymakers, especially from developing countries. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will leverage and use artificial intelligence to collect and support more frequent updates of the non-tariff measures data in the Trade Analysis and Information System (TRAINS)⁵ database, and will enhance the capacity and knowledge of member States to use these data to support their decision-making and regulatory processes through tailored capacity-building.

12.60 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.V).

Figure 12.V

Performance measure: number of biennial updates of non-tariff measures data and number of policymakers using non-tariff measures data



Abbreviation: NTM, non-tariff measures

⁵ Available at: <https://trainsonline.unctad.org/home>.

Deliverables

12.61 Table 12.11 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 12.11

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	21	16	15	16
1. Reports to the General Assembly on international trade and development and world commodity trends and prospects	2	2	1	2
2. Background documentation for the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD	1	–	–	–
3. Reports for the Trade and Development Board	3	3	1	1
4. Background documentation for the Trade and Development Commission	6	3	1	1
5. Reports for the Multi-year Expert Meeting on Commodities and Development	–	–	2 [3]	2
6. Reports for the Multi-year Expert Meeting on Trade, Services and Development	–	–	2	2
7. Reports of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Competition Law and Policy and the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Consumer Protection Law and Policy	9	8	8 [9]	8
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	46	40	30	26
8. Meetings of the General Assembly (Second Committee)	2	2	1	1
9. Meetings of the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD	15	18	–	–
10. Annual and executive sessions of the Trade and Development Board	2	1	2	2
11. Meetings of the Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	2	2	3	3
12. Meetings of the annual sessions of the Trade and Development Commission and related expert meetings	14	6	2	2
13. Meetings of the annual sessions of the Multi-year Expert Meeting on Commodities and Development	–	–	6	4
14. Meetings of the annual sessions of the Multi-year Expert Meeting on Trade, Services and Development	–	–	6	4
15. Meetings of the annual sessions of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Competition Law and Policy and the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Consumer Protection Law and Policy	10	10	10	10
16. Annual meeting of the Intergovernmental Forum on Mining, Minerals, Metals and Sustainable Development	1	1	–	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	20	19	16	17
17. On trade, a gender perspective and development	1	–	1	1
18. On assisting developing countries in acceding to WTO, on generalized and global systems of trade preferences, on services, regional and multilateral trading negotiations, on strengthening the creative economy, and on dispute settlement and commercial diplomacy	6	4	4 [5]	5
19. On competition and consumer protection laws and policies	3	3	2 [3]	2
20. On trade, the environment and development	4	4	3	3
21. On collecting, monitoring, reporting on and disseminating data on non-tariff measures, on formulating development-oriented trade policies, and on sustainability standards	4	6	4	4
22. On assistance to commodity-dependent countries in achieving greater diversification and value addition	2	2	2	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	170	103	123	111
23. On the World Integrated Trade Solution, the Trade Analysis and Information System and non-tariff measures, and sustainability standards	31	19	20 [30]	20

Part IV International cooperation for development

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
24. On preferential trading arrangements, WTO accession, services policies and frameworks, emerging development challenges in the international trading system and trade, international trade negotiations, and the creative economy	44	16.5	25 [42]	22
25. On trade, a gender perspective and development	12	2.5	4 [11]	4
26. On trade, the environment and development	29	25.5	35	25
27. On competition and consumer protection laws and policies	33	19.5	21 [31]	21
28. On supporting commodity-dependent developing countries to formulate strategies and policies and harness development gains, and respond to the challenges and opportunities of commodity markets	10	15	10	10
29. On challenges and opportunities of international trade for the promotion of sustainable development, and on the changing international trade landscape and trade costs	6	4	4	4
30. Ad hoc expert discussions on the role of competition law and policy, and on consumer protection law and policy	1	–	1	–
31. Geneva Trade and Development Workshop series, held jointly by UNCTAD, WTO, the University of Geneva and the Graduate Institute of International and Development Studies	4	–	–	–
32. Annual meeting of the Intergovernmental Forum on Mining, Minerals, Metals and Sustainable Development	–	–	3	3
33. Annual meeting of the Global Commodities Forum	–	1	–	2
Publications (number of publications)	17	19	18	17
34. On trade and the environment	4	6	4 [5]	4
35. On trade, a gender perspective and development	2	1	1 [2]	1
36. On trade, services, the international trading system and the creative economy	3	2	2 [3]	2
37. On trade trends and policy in the international context	3	4	6	5
38. On trade, market efficiency and consumer welfare and on competition and consumer protection policies	2	3	2 [3]	2
39. On trade, commodities, economic diversification and value addition	3	3	3	3
Technical materials (number of materials)	12	10	14	15
40. Global Trade Update	–	–	3	3
41. Reports on UNCTAD work on competition and consumer protection policies and on the Global Commodities Forum	2	4	1 [2]	2
42. Handbooks and policy briefs on classification of non-tariff measures, the Generalized System of Preferences and effective competition and/or consumer protection agencies	3	1	2 [3]	3
43. <i>Manual on Consumer Protection</i>	1	–	1	1
44. Model law on competition	1	1	1	1
45. On competition and consumer protection under the UNCTAD Research Partnership Platform	1	–	1	1
46. UNCTAD, WTO and ITC publication <i>World Tariff Profiles</i>	1	1	1	1
47. Trade-related aspects of the <i>Sustainable Development Goals Report</i>	1	1	1	1
48. United Nations Forum on Sustainability Standards	–	–	1	–
49. On topics in international trade negotiations	2	2	2	2

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice on trade-related decision-making to five member States and two regional South-South economic integration groupings; advice on integration into the global economy and participation in regional and multilateral trade agreements; advice on integration of trade concerns into national trade and services policies; consultation on cooperation and partnerships for inclusive growth and sustainable development; advice on trade and a gender perspective; advice on developing competition and consumer protection frameworks; consultation on trade and environment issues and creative economy potential for sustainable development.

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
Databases and substantive digital materials: World Integrated Trade Solution and Trade Analysis and Information System; online training courses on non-tariff measures for approximately 300 people and on negotiating trade agreements; a teaching package on trade and a gender perspective. D. Communication deliverables Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: global trade updates; policy insights; lectures and exhibits on issues related to the work of the subprogramme; newsletters, brochures, flyers, booklets and fact sheets. External and media relations: news items, press releases, op-ed pieces and media appearances, including podcasts. Digital platforms and multimedia content: interactive tools related to national competition and consumer protection laws, commercial diplomacy and dispute settlement; UNCTAD, WTO and ITC website on trade-related Sustainable Development Goals and indicators.				

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 12).

Subprogramme 4 Technology and logistics

Objective

- 12.62 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to harness innovation and technology, including e-commerce and the digital economy, improve trade logistics and increase human capacities for inclusive and sustainable trade and development in developing countries and economies in transition.

Strategy

- 12.63 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide research and analysis and policy recommendations for harnessing the digital economy and narrowing digital and data divides, including on the challenges of digital and emerging technology such as artificial intelligence, for supporting an enabling environment for digital infrastructure development, for improving digital literacy and skills and for supporting the participation of micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises and women- and youth-led business in the digital economy, and support developing countries in measuring e-commerce and the digital economy;
 - (b) Foster and ensure that the interests of developing countries are identified and integrated into international policy dialogues on e-commerce and the digital economy, including through the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on E-commerce and the Digital Economy and UNCTAD in synergy with the United Nations system and other organizations, and contribute to initiatives, debates and events on digital trade and digital economy from a development perspective, to the implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society architecture and to the implementation of the relevant commitments of the Global Digital Compact;
 - (c) Support developing countries in building their readiness to harness gains from electronic commerce and digital trade, including through eTrade Readiness Assessments and follow-up on the implementation of their policy recommendations, as well as through digital trade negotiation support;
 - (d) Support the development of an enabling environment at all levels for developing countries to mobilize resources through trade and investment, address challenges to their public revenue generation capacity and build circular approaches to the digital economy, to support their digital transformation and the availability of digital public goods, infrastructure and services;

- (e) Ensure that international debates on science, technology and innovation incorporate the perspectives and priorities of developing countries through the Commission on Science and Technology for Development and the Technology Facilitation Mechanism;
- (f) Inform policies and deliberations on science, technology and innovation for development, especially on frontier technologies, and contribute to the implementation of the World Summit on the Information Society architecture and the relevant commitments of the Global Digital Compact, including by servicing the work of the Working Group on Data Governance of the Commission on Science and Technology for Development;
- (g) Foster international cooperation in science, technology and innovation, including through the Commission on Science and Technology for Development, to support national action through capacity-building and effective policy frameworks, and continue to support member States, especially developing countries, in collaboration with other relevant institutions, to enhance their capacity for innovation, research, development and applications of safe, secure and trustworthy emerging technologies, including artificial intelligence;
- (h) Support the implementation of trade facilitation reforms, in particular the WTO Agreement on Trade Facilitation, as well as capacity-building for National Trade Facilitation Committees and bodies to increase the harmonization and coordination of trade facilitation measures at the national and regional levels, and continue its support for the development and implementation of appropriate legal and regulatory frameworks that reduce trade transaction costs;
- (i) Provide technical assistance, leveraging the flagship customs software and associated capacity-building of the Automated System for Customs Data to boost member States' capacity to support sustainable economic transformation, collect revenue, protect society and secure borders;
- (j) Deliver technical guidance on data and policy recommendations and promote the sharing of best practices regarding the formulation and integration of strategic national policies, with the aim of integrating developing countries into regional and global supply and value chains and transport networks. This includes the flagship publication *Review of Maritime Transport* and other research products, advice on legislative frameworks and capacity-building, including the TrainForTrade programme on port management;
- (k) Continue to assist in designing and implementing policies and actions aimed at improving the efficiency of the management of transport operations, trade transactions and logistics, including through the digitalization and electronic exchange of trade-related documents, and support international and regional transport networks through policy dialogue and cooperation mechanisms, ensuring their sustainability and resilience, including the organization of the UNCTAD Global Supply Chain Forum;
- (l) Foster international policy dialogue on trade logistics issues, addressing the interests and challenges of developing countries in regional and international forums and focusing on specific vulnerabilities of landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, including through advocacy on transport, logistics and trade facilitation to enhance their resilience;
- (m) Support developing countries in sustainably harnessing the ocean economy and implementing international commitments on maritime transport and ocean governance;
- (n) Mainstream the cross-cutting issue of gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls across the three pillars of the subprogramme, with a special focus on empowering women digital entrepreneurs and enhancing their digital skills and opportunities.

12.64 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Improved capacity and policy formulation at the national, regional and global levels on e-commerce, digital trade and digital economy for sustainable and inclusive development;

- (b) Improved coordination among Governments, together with development partners, civil society and the private sector, to implement policies on e-commerce and the digital economy that work for sustainable and inclusive development;
- (c) Improved knowledge and understanding of policy options by policymakers and international consensus on emerging challenges and opportunities in science, technology and innovation for sustainable and inclusive development, as well as increased capacity of policymakers to assess, analyse and formulate policies on key issues on the international economic agenda;
- (d) Member States implementing the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society and of the Technology Facilitation Mechanism;
- (e) Member States harnessing science, technology and innovation for their national development strategies;
- (f) Countries addressing key and emerging issues in trade logistics, as well as regional and global supply chains, including maritime transport policies and port management and effective implementation of relevant international commitments on maritime transport and ocean governance;
- (g) Member States implementing trade facilitation reforms, including the WTO Agreement on Trade Facilitation;
- (h) Enhanced capacity of member States to design and implement policies and action aimed at improving the efficiency of trade transactions and of the management of transport operations, including through the Automated System for Customs Data programme.

Programme performance in 2025

Developing countries advance the conceptualization and development of science, technology and innovation parks for sustainable development

12.65 For developing countries, the ability to design and manage effective science, technology and innovation parks can help to foster innovation-led growth, stimulating local enterprise development and creating productive employment opportunities. To help to advance this, the subprogramme enhanced the capacity of policymakers and practitioners from four developing countries (Ghana, Mongolia, Mozambique and Uzbekistan) to design, operate and manage science, technology and innovation parks through a dedicated initiative aimed at strengthening policy and operational capacities and building expertise and practice. The subprogramme support included tailored capacity-building, peer learning and South-South knowledge exchange, and technical guidance and analysis such as a policy toolkit.

12.66 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.12).

Table 12.12
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	Ghana, Mozambique, Mongolia and Uzbekistan finalized in-depth national diagnostics and road maps to better leverage science, technology and innovation parks to drive technological innovation and economic development	Thirteen institutions and experts from Ghana, Mongolia, Mozambique and Uzbekistan joined a science, technology and innovation park expert network, allowing them to promote knowledge exchange, policy learning and international cooperation

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: improved availability of digital economy statistics in developing countries

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.67 The subprogramme's work contributed to 29 Member States participating in the development of internationally agreed guidelines and recommendations on measuring e-commerce value, which did not meet the planned target of two countries starting to use internationally agreed guidelines. The target was not met due to delayed completion of the work to develop the guidelines and recommendations owing to budget constraints related to the liquidity situation.
- 12.68 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.13).

Table 12.13

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Establishment of the international task group on measuring e-commerce value	Twenty-three Member States participated in developing internationally agreed guidelines and recommendations on measuring e-commerce value	Twenty-nine Member States participated in the development of internationally agreed guidelines and recommendations on measuring e-commerce value	At least two countries start using the guidelines	At least two additional countries start using the guidelines

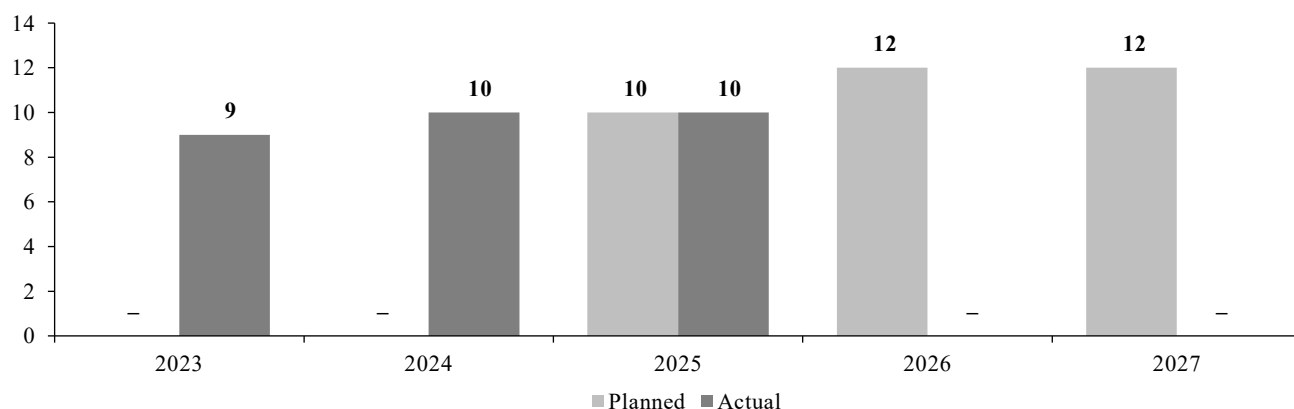
Result 2: enhanced efficiency and sustainability of trade procedures

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.69 The subprogramme's work contributed to a cumulative total of 10 government agencies in six countries (Jamaica, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Tajikistan, Timor-Leste, Vanuatu and Zimbabwe) transitioning from paper-based procedures to digitalized procedures through the implementation of the Automated System for Customs Data, which met the planned target.
- 12.70 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.VI).

Figure 12.VI

Performance measure: number of government agencies transitioning from paper-based procedures to digitalized procedures through the implementation of the Automated System for Customs Data (cumulative)



Result 3: strengthening inclusion in trade facilitation

Proposed programme plan for 2027

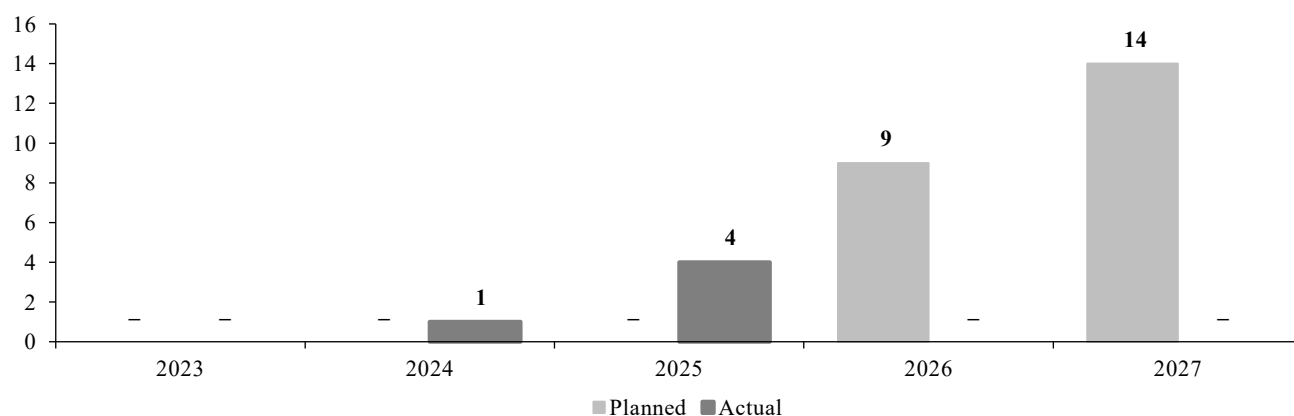
- 12.71 Harnessing inclusiveness is among the core Sustainable Development Goal objectives, while inclusive trade is a prerequisite for sustainable growth. Simplification, harmonization, standardization and digitalization of procedures and processes can yield outsized benefits for micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, many of which are owned by women cross-border traders, as well as other people in vulnerable situations such as persons with disabilities. The subprogramme, through its Empowerment Programme for Trade Facilitation, has been assisting member States in devising policies, procedures, recommendations or workplans to ensure that cross-border trade is inclusive while reducing trade time and costs and improving supply chain efficiency.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 12.72 The lesson for the subprogramme was that assisting member States in the implementation of trade facilitation reforms also required a focused approach on inclusion in trade facilitation in terms of working with National Trade Facilitation Committees. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will support National Trade Facilitation Committees and government agencies in the implementation of targeted actions to devise policies procedures, recommendations or workplans for strengthening inclusion.
- 12.73 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 12.VII).

Figure 12.VII

Performance measure: number of National Trade Facilitation Committees introducing aspects of inclusion of women and girls and persons with disabilities into recommendations, workplans, policies or procedures on trade facilitation (cumulative)



Deliverables

12.74 Table 12.14 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 12.14

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	21	18	18	17
1. Reports to the General Assembly on the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society, and on science and technology for development	3	3	1 [3]	1
2. Reports to the Commission on Science and Technology for Development and its intersessional panels	6	6	5 [6]	4
3. Reports and background documentation for the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD	1	1	—	—
4. Background notes and reports for the Trade and Development Board	2	2	2	2
5. Note by the UNCTAD secretariat and reports for the Investment, Enterprise and Development Commission and related expert meetings on issues related to science, technology and innovation	1	1	2	2
6. Note by the UNCTAD secretariat and reports for the Trade and Development Commission and related expert meetings	4	1	4	4
7. Note by the UNCTAD secretariat and reports for the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on E-commerce and the Digital Economy	2	2	2	2
8. Note by the UNCTAD secretariat and reports for the Working Group on Measuring E-commerce and the Digital Economy	2	2	2	2
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	56	41	46	39
9. Meetings of the General Assembly (Second Committee) and the Economic and Social Council on the follow-up to the World Summit on the Information Society	2	2	2	2
10. Meetings of the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD, including preparatory sessions	4	4	—	—
11. Annual session and intersessional expert panels of the Commission on Science and Technology for Development	16	12	16	12

Section 12 Trade and development

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
12. Meetings of the Working Group on Data Governance of the Commission on Science and Technology for Development	–	3	–	2
13. Annual and executive sessions of the Trade and Development Board	3	2	3	3
14. Meetings of the Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	2	2	2	3
15. Annual sessions of the Investment, Enterprise and Development Commission and related expert meetings	4	2	4	–
16. Annual sessions of the Trade and Development Commission and related expert meetings on transport, trade logistics and trade facilitation	7	–	5 [7]	5
17. Meetings of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts on E-commerce and the Digital Economy	6	6	6	6
18. Meetings of the Working Group on Measuring E-commerce and the Digital Economy	4	4	4	4
19. Multi-stakeholder forum on science, technology and innovation for the Sustainable Development Goals of the Technology Facilitation Mechanism	2	2	2	2
20. Meetings for UNCTAD eWeek	6	2	1	–
21. Meetings of the Global Supply Chain Forum	–	–	1	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	26	48	26	27
22. Training Development in the Field of International Trade (TrainForTrade) capacity-building programme: port management; issues related to trade, including e-commerce and statistics; pedagogical methodology	1	7	1	1
23. National, regional and interregional projects on transport and related services, including the Automated System for Customs Data	22	22	22	22
24. Transport, trade facilitation and trade logistics	2	18	2	2
25. E-commerce and the digital economy programme	1	1	1	1
26. Effective policy frameworks in science, technology and innovation	–	–	–	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	417	413.5	391	389
27. TrainForTrade seminars, workshops and training sessions	300	305	300	300
28. Seminars, workshops, fellowships and training events on transport, trade logistics and trade facilitation	52	75	45 [52]	45
29. Ad hoc expert discussions on transport, trade logistics and trade facilitation	1	1	1	1
30. Seminar on the role of technology and innovation in development, including for the operationalization of technology transfer, including ad hoc expert discussions	1	1	1	1
31. Seminars, workshops and training events on e-commerce and the digital economy for development, including on information economy statistics, economic, technical, legal and regulatory aspects of e-commerce and the digital economy for development and e-commerce, and measuring the digital economy and eTrade for Women	12	12	12	10
32. Training courses on key issues on the international economic agenda (paragraph 166 of the Bangkok Plan of Action), regional and short courses	36	3.5	20 [36]	20
33. Seminars, workshops and training events on science, technology and innovation and development	15	16	12 [15]	12
Publications (number of publications)	14	15	17	15
34. <i>Technology and Innovation Report</i> and its overview	1	2	2	–
35. <i>Digital Economy Report</i> and its overview	–	–	2	2
36. <i>Review of Maritime Transport</i> and its overview	1	2	2	2
37. Reports on science, technology and innovation policy reviews	1	1	1	1
38. E-commerce strategies	2	2	2	2
39. <i>Current Studies on Science, Technology and Innovation</i> series	1	1	1	1
40. Transport and trade logistics and transport and trade facilitation series	2	1	2	2
41. Thematic reports on e-commerce and the digital economy, including statistics, cyberlaw and a gender perspective	2	2	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
42. TrainForTrade <i>Port Management</i> series	1	1	1	1
43. eTrade Readiness Assessments	3	3	3	3
Technical materials (number of materials)	13	11	9	10
44. Policy briefs on the following topics: science, technology and innovation; e-commerce and the digital economy; and trade logistics	4	2	3 [4]	2
45. Automated System for Customs Data annual report	1	1	1	1
46. <i>Year in Review</i> of the e-commerce and the digital economy programme	1	1	1	1
47. Technical notes on information and communications technology for development	2	1	– [2]	2
48. Technical notes on trade facilitation	1	–	– [1]	–
49. Background notes for the multi-stakeholder forum on science, technology and innovation for the Sustainable Development Goals	1	1	1	1
50. Economic and maritime country profiles	1	1	1	1
51. Report of the UNCTAD TrainForTrade Advisory Group on Strengthening Training Capacity and Human Resource Development	1	1	1	1
52. Technical note on science, technology and innovation for development	1	3	1	1

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services in the area of e-commerce and the digital economy; multi-stakeholder forum on science, technology and innovation for the Sustainable Development Goals; sessions of the UNCTAD TrainForTrade Advisory Group on Strengthening Training Capacity and Human Resource Development; policy advice on science, technology and innovation policies for development; consultations on policy and practical aspects of e-commerce and the digital economy, transport policies and international legal instrument standards and rules related to the facilitation of international trade, transport and supply chains; consultations on port operations and the eTrade for All initiative.

Databases and substantive digital materials: UNCTAD platform for learning and capacity-building by the TrainForTrade programme, which trains approximately 1,500 beneficiaries annually; port performance statistics platform; online repository on National Trade Facilitation Committees; Global Cyberlaw Tracker; online e-learning modules for the courses on key issues on the international economic agenda, for 200 users annually; online platform for the courses on key issues on the international economic agenda, for 200 users annually; online platform for sustainable and resilient freight transport; eTrade for All online platform; digital economy statistics in the UNCTADstat database; maritime transport and seaborne trade statistics in the UNCTADstat data centre; maritime country profiles on the UNCTAD Data Hub.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: newsletters on the Automated System for Customs Data and eTrade for All for more than 5,000 subscribers; newsletter on science, technology and innovation; brochures, flyers and information kits.

External and media relations: press releases, press briefings, interviews, press conferences and news items related to the issuance of major publications under the subprogramme and the organization of important events.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: TrainForTrade; Commission on Science and Technology for Development; Automated System for Customs Data and paragraph 166 of the Bangkok Plan of Action website; eTrade for All platform; online platforms for innovation policy learning and for sustainable and resilient freight transport.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 12).

Subprogramme 5 Africa, least developed countries and special programmes

Objective

- 12.75 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to enhance the effective integration of Africa, the least developed countries and other groups of countries in special situations (landlocked developing countries, small island developing States and other structurally weak, vulnerable and small

economies) into the global economy through fostering sustainable structural economic transformation, reducing vulnerabilities and developing domestic productive capacities in the targeted groups.

Strategy

12.76 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:

- (a) Carry out research and technical cooperation activities to diversify the exports, foster the productive capacities and explore the financing structures of the above-mentioned countries, including through contributions to the reports of the Secretary-General to the General Assembly and the reports on the implementation and follow-up of relevant agendas and programmes of action;
- (b) Implement technical cooperation programmes and develop strategic evidence- and policy-based options to promote sustainable structural economic transformation through productive capacity-building, diversification and support aimed at addressing vulnerability and building resilience, in particular for developing countries;
- (c) Advocate for consensus in the international development community regarding the policy measures that best address the sustainable development problems of least developed countries, small island developing States and landlocked developing countries, including at the multilateral level, through the identification of new policy approaches and methodologies, training and capacity-building workshops, including for parliamentarians, as well as greater interaction with research institutes in least developed countries and other developing countries, and with development partners;
- (d) Strengthen efforts to provide domestic policy support and capacity-building to the targeted groups derived from its innovative research and analysis, development of analytical tools and technical support;
- (e) Provide technical support to least developed countries that are either in the process of graduation or recently graduated from the least developed country category, and including through the provision of General Assembly-mandated vulnerability profiles, as applicable, to ensure timely support leading to their graduation with momentum and a smooth transition towards their new status;
- (f) Broaden its country-based technical support to include aspects such as national strategies for the development of productive capacities and structural economic transformation, inclusive trade, regional trade integration, rules of origin, inequality, poverty and vulnerability, enhanced market access and preference utilization, value addition in strategic products and geographical indications;
- (g) Support member States in addressing the socioeconomic impact of external shocks on economies in target countries, through research work and technical cooperation, in order to facilitate specific, data-driven policy design and implementation aimed at building resilience;
- (h) Support African countries in addressing their special concerns and needs, including as articulated in the New Partnership for Africa's Development and in Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want, and in implementing the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area through research, technical cooperation and targeted policy advice;
- (i) Deliver training, capacity-building activities and ad hoc research on market access, the productive capacities index, trade preferences and rules of origin to support the WTO least developed countries group in identifying and negotiating, in line with the needs of the group, result-oriented common positions for the relevant WTO committee meetings.

12.77 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Enhanced role of productive capacities in fostering structural economic transformation for inclusive growth and development in beneficiary countries;

- (b) The development and implementation by member States of evidence-based policies and programmes to deepen domestic and regional markets and accelerate industrialization and socioeconomic transformation;
- (c) Improved development policy formulation and implementation capacities in countries with specific needs, including the least developed countries and small island developing States, for enhanced resilience and structural transformations;
- (d) The adoption by graduating countries of policies and strategies, including to support a smooth transition out of the least developed country category;
- (e) Enhanced implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area by member States;
- (f) Greater participation by member States in multilateral forums dedicated to enhanced trade through transparent, predictable and simple rules of origin;
- (g) Improved development policy formulation, implementation and monitoring capacities of member States, including greater policy coherence, and capacities to account for current and future shocks, reduce exposure to external shocks and build resilience;
- (h) Stronger representation of the interests of least developed countries in WTO policy discussions and ministerial meetings;
- (i) Progress by member States, in particular least developed countries and other groups of countries in special situations, towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 8, 9, 10 and 17.

Programme performance in 2025

Least developed countries identify a common position on rules of origin and agenda for the Fourteenth Ministerial Conference of the World Trade Organization

- 12.78 The subprogramme supports the least developed countries group in WTO negotiations on rules of origin by providing technical assistance to help them to better understand WTO agreements and effectively articulate their interests in the multilateral trading system. Ahead of the Fourteenth Ministerial Conference of WTO, the subprogramme has expanded the scope of its training to effectively assist the least developed countries group in gaining a clearer understanding of the strategic issues shaping the negotiations and in identifying concrete pathways to enhance their use of preferential market access, and to help the group to formulate its position on the issue and introduce a proposal to be included in the outcome document.
- 12.79 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.15).

Table 12.15

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Twenty-one delegates of the WTO least developed countries group jointly engaged in multilateral trade negotiations	Delegates of the WTO least developed countries group jointly presented an updated paper consolidating requests to preference-granting members regarding preferential rules of origin that was informed by UNCTAD analysis on “de facto convergence” in product-specific rules of origin

2023 (actual)

2024 (actual)

2025 (actual)

States members of the WTO least developed countries group converged on a single position on rules of origin and other trade-related regulatory practices in the run-up to the Fourteenth Ministerial Conference of WTO

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: enhanced statistical capacity of least developed countries and other developing countries, to help embrace a paradigm shift in the formulation of holistic economic diversification policies

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 12.80 The subprogramme's work contributed to Angola and Kenya registering a 1.2 and 1.9 per cent increase, respectively, on the productive capacities index, contributing to structural economic transformation, which met the planned target.
- 12.81 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.16).

Table 12.16

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Second generation of the productive capacities index was made available to member States	Ethiopia and Nigeria referred to productive capacities in their national development strategies, including the productive capacities index Member States have access to the updated database on rates of utilization of the Generalized System of Preferences Representatives of 11 least developed countries benefited from statistical training	Angola and Kenya registered a 1.2 and 1.9 per cent increase, respectively, on the productive capacities index, contributing to their structural economic transformation	At least four least developed countries or other vulnerable countries develop holistic programmes to foster productive capacities using the productive capacities index	An additional two least developed countries or other vulnerable countries develop holistic programmes to foster productive capacities using the productive capacities index

Result 2: enhanced capacity of small island developing States to build productive capacities**Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 12.82 The subprogramme's work contributed to enhanced statistical capacity in measuring productive capacities, including use of the productive capacities index methodology in national statistics in Antigua and Barbuda, the Dominican Republic, Jamaica and Trinidad and Tobago, which exceeded the planned target of two small island developing States.
- 12.83 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.17).

Table 12.17

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
The Comoros has access to National Productive Capacities Gap Assessments	Increased understanding of Antigua and Barbuda, Maldives and Saint Vincent and the Grenadines on how productive capacities contribute to building socioeconomic resilience and on the role of the productive capacities index in supporting integration into global and regional value chains	Enhanced statistical capacity in the productive capacities index methodology and its use in national statistics in Antigua and Barbuda, the Dominican Republic, Jamaica and Trinidad and Tobago	At least two small island developing States use the productive capacities index to identify productive capacity-enabling policies in selected relevant sectors	At least two small island developing States complete the National Productive Capacity Gap Assessments

Result 3: least developed countries enabled to formulate and implement inclusive and coherent trade policies**Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 12.84 International trade can support sustained growth in least developed countries, but its benefits can be uneven and may exacerbate inequality. The subprogramme supports least developed countries in identifying trade and other economic policies that are supportive of the goals of inequality and poverty reduction through policy-oriented research on the interlinkages between trade and poverty.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 12.85 The lesson for the subprogramme was that its trade-related assistance better supports poverty reduction when it explicitly integrates inclusion and addresses coherence with other economic and sectoral policies geared towards poverty eradication. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will enhance the capacity of least developed countries to formulate and implement inclusive trade strategies that are coherent with macroeconomic and sectoral policies to foster poverty reduction through tailored analysis, policy options and capacity-building activities.
- 12.86 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 12.18).

Table 12.18
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Burkina Faso equipped with tailored analysis of various sectoral policies and their impact on poverty and inequality reduction, and policy options to tackle poverty and inequality	Chad and the United Republic of Tanzania equipped with tailored analysis of various sectoral policies and their impact on poverty and inequality reduction, and policy options to address poverty and inequality	An additional least developed country is equipped with policy options to address inequality and reduce poverty	A least developed country undertakes specific actions to apply policy options for addressing inequality and reducing poverty

Deliverables

12.87 Table 12.19 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 12.19
Subprogramme 5: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	4	4	5	5
1. Reports for the Economic and Social Council, including on vulnerability profiles	1	1	3	3
2. Reports for the Trade and Development Board on UNCTAD-wide activities for least developed countries and UNCTAD-wide activities in favour of Africa	2	2	2	2
3. Reports and background documentation for the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD	1	1	—	—
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	14	14	8	8
4. Meetings of the General Assembly and the Economic and Social Council and its Committee for Development Policy	1	1	1	1
5. Meetings of the sixteenth quadrennial session of UNCTAD, including preparatory sessions	6	6	—	—
6. Annual and executive sessions of the Trade and Development Board	5	5	5	5
7. Meetings of the Working Party on the Programme Plan and Programme Performance	2	2	2	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	2	7
8. On trade, finance, transit and development to build national capacity	1	1	2	7
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	50	61	39	44
9. On trade issues relevant to least developed and African countries, including on duty-free and quota-free market access, structural transformation and support for least developed country graduation	22	36	20	20

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
10. On the implementation of the new initiatives that will replace the Vienna Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2014–2024 and the Antigua and Barbuda Agenda for Small Island Developing States, issues of thematic or sectoral relevance to landlocked developing countries, the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries for the decade 2022–2031, national productive gap assessments and holistic development programmes, and trade and poverty	20	17	13 [20]	13
11. On matters relevant to development in least developed countries and Africa	8	8	6	11
Publications (number of publications)	12	7	7	7
12. <i>The Least Developed Countries Report</i> and its overview	2	2	2	2
13. <i>The Economic Development in Africa Report</i> and its overview	2	–	2	2
14. Report on building and measuring productive capacities	1	1	–	–
15. Report on enhancing coherence between trade and industrial strategies for poverty eradication in Africa and a special issues paper on Africa	1	1	1	1
16. Analytical studies on duty-free and quota-free market access and rules of origin	1	1	–	–
17. Lessons learned on geographical indications and related analysis for least developed countries	1	–	–	–
18. Sectoral, statistical and thematic issues of interest for developing countries: policy implications for fostering productive capacities and structural economic transformation and on the national productive capacities gap assessments	2	–	1 [2]	1
19. Research papers on economic development issues in least developed countries and Africa	2	2	1 [2]	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	7	6	5	6
20. Technical material on trade and poverty	1	1	1	1
21. Technical material on trade and development in vulnerable economies, including small island developing States	5	5	4	4
22. Technical material on transit, transport and trade facilitation	1	–	– [1]	1

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: policy advice to ministries of trade, transport and planning on the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034 and to national statistical offices on measuring productive capacities for targeted groups of countries; advice on strategies for graduation with momentum for graduating and graduated least developed countries; advice on trade and development issues for small island developing States, landlocked developing countries and African countries; advice for least developed countries on trade issues relevant to them; consultations on UNCTAD activities related to the New Partnership for Africa’s Development; and consultations with United Nations partner agencies and African countries for the implementation of the Third Industrial Development Decade for Africa.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: lectures on issues related to least developed countries and African development, trade policy, globalization, trade development strategies and policy coherence for the benefit of member States, for a minimum of 100 participants; and policy briefs related flagship reports.

External and media relations: press releases, press conferences and interviews and opinion pieces on flagship reports and other topical research, including policy recommendations.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 12).